

1. Which type of ideas do you think apply to Shyp? Why?

I think the ideas that apply to Shyp are Simplify and Virtualize. Simplify because it makes the overall process of shipping items much easier for the user as they only need to take a picture and provide a pickup location for the item. Virtualize because it takes the process of shipping items in real life to the online web.

2. Which type of ideas do you think apply to Curofy? Why?

The ideas that apply to Curofy are Me Too, Remix, and Simplify. Me Too because Curofy is similar to LinkedIn but they curated it towards doctors specifically. Remix because it serves as a source of medical news and provides communication with other doctors. And simplify because it makes communication with other doctors easier.

3. Use [Product Hunt](#) to find a relatively new startup and respond to the following about it:

- Describe the idea.

The product I chose was called Vibe Eyes. The product's idea is that you can place a small animated avatar of your pet onto your macOS menu bar. The animated avatar will follow your cursor, wink at you, and other small cute stuff like that.

- Describe the type(s) of ideas that apply to it.

I'm a bit unsure of exactly what ideas apply to this product. I don't think it's simplify because it's just a customizable avatar which doesn't necessarily make any process easier. I don't think it's Me Too, Virtualize, or Mission Impossible either. The only idea that I think could possibly apply to the product is Remix, because it combines macOS widgets with customizable pet avatars.

- Is the idea a painkiller or a vitamin? That is, does the idea address users' needs or emotions? Why?

The idea is definitely a vitamin because it addresses the user's emotions, providing some relief if they're missing their pets while away. It's a fun way to symbolize to the user that their pet is still with them on their computer.

- Is the idea easy to monetize?

I think so, the creator of the product mentioned that the app comes with pre-set pets that users could choose from. If the user wanted to create their own pet avatar to better resemble their pet, they could pay a one time purchase fee of \$14.99. The overall purpose of the product is to help

pet owners missing their pets while away, and so I assume they would want the pet on their menu bar to look like their actual pet rather than a random one.

- Is the idea simple and easy to describe?

Yes, I find the idea to be very simple to describe as it's just an app that helps people missing their pets while away from them.

- Is the idea personally relevant? Are you or is someone close to you connected to the idea or the related problem?

Yes, funny enough one of my uncle's recently adopted a cat. He's been obsessed with her and is constantly anxious when he's away from her. He purchased a camera to see what she was up to when he's at work or away from home. He also likes customizing his iPhone and laptop very much, so I think a product like this is very relevant to me personally.

- Does the idea have a large market?

I think so. The product targets mostly pet owners, as well as users who just want to customize their macOS menu bar. I think people in general like to customize their technology so the potential customers and market is very promising for the product.

- Does the idea have a legitimate secret sauce?

I guess the secret sauce might just be that it appeals to people who really love their pets and that makes them willing to spend the \$15 to customize the pet to look like theirs.

A. Brainstorming

Answer the following questions in your document:

1. Brainstorm ideas of problems you want to solve with software like an app or website. Include all the problems you came up with in your document.

Finding what professors are good is difficult, and RateMyProfessor has too many issues, like far too many ads / pop ups. Text books are too expensive when you'll use them for one class and never again.

2. Brainstorm ways to solve the problems. Include all the solutions you came up with in your document.

An improved version of RateMyProfessor with less ads/popups and a messaging system so users could communicate with each other. An app that allows students

to post textbooks they no longer need for other students to take, could be at a discounted price or for free.

3. Choose one of your ideas as your product that you will turn into a website for this course. Why did you pick this idea over the other candidates?

I decided to choose the textbook idea because I found that I have several textbooks in my room just sitting around being unused when I spent upwards of \$50 for each of them. I think being able to find someone who needs them would be nice so that they don't have to spend money and I can free up space in my room.

4. Is your idea a new one or has it existed before?

I'm not sure if there is specifically a product that helps students find textbooks, Facebook marketplace / eBay are some similar ideas I can think of but they are much broader than my idea.

5. What industry would your idea be useful in? Why? (i.e., advertising, apparel, arts, automotive, cosmetics, education, entertainment, food, etc.)

It would be useful in the education industry because it focuses on helping students find cheaper textbooks and also allows the students to sell them for a discounted price after they're done using it for the class.

B. Product Proposal

Answer the following questions in your document:

1. Describe the product you have come up with and the type(s) of ideas that apply to it.

The product I've come up with is Recyclopedia, an app designed to help students look for cheap textbooks, while also allowing students to sell textbooks they no longer need. The types of ideas that apply to it are Simplify, because it makes the process of finding / selling textbooks easier. Virtualize, because students can look online for textbooks rather than in physical stores. Me Too, because it is similar to Facebook marketplace but is focused on textbook recycling. And Remix, because it'll combine a marketplace with a messaging system.

2. How is your product personally relevant to you? Are you or is someone close to you connected to the idea or the related problem?

The product is personally relevant to me because I'm a student who has purchased textbooks in the past, and now that I no longer have the need to use them I think they'd be better in another student's hands who actually needs them.

I along with my friends at URI are connected to the problem and idea as I'm sure they feel similarly.

3. What problem will your product solve?

High textbook prices and wasting of textbooks.

4. What type of website will your product be? (i.e., blog, business, brochure, etc.)

Definitely a business website.

5. Is your product a painkiller or a vitamin? That is, does it address users' needs or emotions? Why?

I think it is a painkiller because it addresses students' needs for cheaper textbooks.

6. Is your product easy to monetize?

I think so, either having transactions that go through the app could have 15% of the total revenue as a commission fee. Or we could implement small ad banners on the app to make passive revenue if students prefer to pay with cash or give away their textbooks for free.

7. Is your product simple and easy to describe?

Yes, it's an app that recycles textbooks connecting students so that textbooks are cheaper and not being wasted.

8. Who will be the likely users of your product? Does your product have a large market?

The likely users of my product will be students or anyone looking for textbooks. I think the product has a large market because there are so many students and I believe everyone would be happier purchasing textbooks for cheaper.

9. Does your product have a legitimate secret sauce?

Nope, just an app that wants to help students!